Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report on

Ty Banwen

Treharris

Date Inspection Completed

01/05/2024

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About Ty Banwen

Type of care provided	Care Home Service Children's Home
Registered Provider	Priority Childcare Limited
Registered places	1
Language of the service	English
Previous Care Inspectorate Wales inspection	First Inspection
Does this service promote Welsh language and culture?	This service does not provide an 'Active Offer' of the Welsh language and does not demonstrate a significant effort to promoting the use of the Welsh language and culture.

Summary

Children are making good progress at Ty Banwen. They attend school and see people who are important in their lives. Children's health needs are known and understood, and action is taken to ensure they receive the support they need and have opportunities to engage in activities of their choosing.

The home has a team of care staff who work across two services and are led by a manager who oversees two homes operated by the service provider. The manager ensures they are available for children and care staff and care staff told us they were accessible and responsive to support the service to operate effectively. The environment is clean, warm, welcoming and well maintained.

The Responsible Individual (RI) visits regularly to complete quality assurance checks and considers the quality of service provided. A review of the quality of care ensures the ongoing development and improvement of the service to support children achieve the best possible outcomes.

Well-being

Children are consulted about their care and can voice their opinions, preferences, likes and dislikes. Their views are requested and considered through a number of ways including monthly online surveys, keyworking sessions and house meetings. Children were observed to have positive, warm relationships with care staff who genuinely care for them and are committed to improving their lives. Children told us they participate in activities of their choice and spend time doing what they enjoy and care staff encourage them to attend clubs and try new sports. Children have been active in raising money for charity by holding bake sales supported by care staff.

Children are registered with health services including GP, opticians, dentists and attend routine appointments. Care staff ensure they receive the care and support they need to promote their physical and emotional health and well-being. Children are supported to attend mainstream school and have education plans in place.

The environment supports children's overall well-being. The home is clean, tidy, and suitable for children. The building is safe from unauthorised access and well maintained. Visitors are requested to sign in and out of the service.

Care staff report they work in a positive environment, with a strong staff team and feel supported and listened to by seniors and management. There is a children's guide to living in the home, this gives a detailed guide for young people about the rules of the home, their entitlements, and how to make a complaint. Children can be assured they are cared for by care staff who understand their safeguarding responsibilities, all care staff have completed their safeguarding training and there is an up-to-date safeguarding policy. Children have access to an advocate, should they wish to use this service.

Care and Support

Children are well presented and observed to be comfortable in their surroundings. They are supported to spend time with their families and those that are important to them and care staff told us children's friends come to the home. Children are supported to attend clubs including cadets and they take part in activities including building models with care staff, baking, fishing, mountain biking, skateboarding and swimming with friends. Children are supported to have pets and encouraged to take responsibility for feeding and cleaning fish tanks.

Trauma informed positive behaviour plans and impact risk assessments are developed to provide comprehensive information to support children's behaviour, these are updated regularly and signed by children's social workers. Child friendly personal plans are completed, and copies are provided to children. Provider assessments are in place, they detail children's personal outcomes and individual risks, these are reviewed in line with regulations. Keyworking sessions take place regularly and topics discussed cover areas to improve outcomes and support children to meet identified targets.

Feedback from social workers is positive, 'They demonstrate a sound ability to follow the children's respective care plans and understand their needs. Ty Banwen demonstrate flexibility to adapt to any presenting behaviours.' Incidents and physical interventions are minimal, where these have occurred, they have been low level, debriefs with children and care staff take place and records of these events are sufficiently detailed and have management oversight.

Staff understand their duty to report safeguarding matters and children told us they feel safe and are clear about the systems in place to achieve this. Records were seen where children were requested to provide receipts for purchases and money spent on activities, the RI gave assurances that they had recently become aware of this and had already taken action to ensure this practice does not continue.

Environment

Children benefit from an environment which is suitable for their needs. The home is clean, light, warm and welcoming with a cozy feel. The home is well decorated and maintained and furniture and fittings are of good quality.

There is sufficient communal space for staff to play and eat together, and the living room is decorated in colours linked to children's interests. Children can personalise their bedrooms and are given choices on the colours, their bedrooms reflect their interests and are decorated with photographs and personal items. Care staff told us 'We try our best to run like a normal family house for the young people rather than it being a work environment, by doing this we have kept the house warm and welcoming with choice from the young people of colours, pictures and even down to picking their own furniture.' The kitchen was clean and fit for purpose, it contained all the necessary appliances. The fridge was well stocked, and food was appropriately labelled. The service has been awarded a food hygiene score of four (good). The rear garden is an enclosed area, there is currently no outside storage, but care staff told us that this has been actioned and they are awaiting maintenance to complete this.

All necessary health and safety checks are in place and there is a clear filing system in place. Gas and electricity safety testing is up to date. The fire risk assessment is on file and records indicate regular checks are undertaken of fire systems. Fire drills take place with staff and children to ensure they understand what action to take in an emergency and recommendations from a fire service visit have been actioned. Checks are routinely undertaken of visitors to the home and their identification checked.

Leadership and Management

The statement of purpose for the home accurately describes how the service is delivered. Care staff work between two services located close to each other, they told us they enjoy this and feel working between two services supports their personal development. Care staff told us they have a strong team, they feel listened to, supported by management, training provided helps them to meet the needs of the children they provide care for and that 'Ty Banwen is an amazing place to work with lots of opportunities to progress within the company'.

Children can be assured they are cared for by staff who have been subject to safe recruitment checks. Recruitment files we viewed were well organised and included all the required information and checks. Care staff complete a range of mandatory and additional training to support their skills development. Newly employed care staff complete the service's induction programme and the Social Care Wales (SCW) induction framework and are encouraged and supported to gain relevant qualifications. Care staff remain in probation until the SCW induction framework is completed.

Team meetings take place monthly; records of these meetings are detailed and actions from the last meeting are followed up. Care staff receive regular supervision. The complaints process is clear, the records are robust and the outcomes are recorded. The office and files are well organised and there are clear systems in place. Files are not separately locked away in cupboards, however, the office door is kept locked. Systems are in place to protect children and keep them safe and care staff have attended safeguarding training.

There is strong and effective leadership and oversight of the service. The RI visits the service and completes quality assurance reports in line with regulations and there are appropriate arrangements in place to support the operation of the service. RI reports are comprehensive and detailed, they consult with children as well as seeking feedback from care staff and other professionals. Care Inspectorate Wales (CIW) receive notifications in line with regulations.

Summary of Non-Compliance	
Status	**What each means**
New	This non-compliance was identified at this inspection.
Reviewed	Compliance was reviewed at this inspection and was not achieved. The target date for compliance is in the future and will be tested at next inspection.
Not Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was not achieved.
Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was achieved.

We respond to non-compliance with regulations where poor outcomes for people, and / or risk to people's well-being are identified by issuing Priority Action Notice (s).

The provider must take immediate steps to address this and make improvements. Where providers fail to take priority action by the target date we may escalate the matter to an Improvement and Enforcement Panel.

Priority Action Notice(s)		
Regulation	Summary	Status
N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

Where we find non-compliance with regulations but no immediate or significant risk for people using the service is identified we highlight these as Areas for Improvement.

We expect the provider to take action to rectify this and we will follow this up at the next inspection. Where the provider has failed to make the necessary improvements we will escalate the matter by issuing a Priority Action Notice.

Area(s) for Improvement		
Regulation	Summary	Status

N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

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